

Coffee and conservation

M D Madhusudan explained the unlikely link between organic coffee and deforestation in Karnataka

Peak visualisation

David Bolinsky's H1N1 animation of the disease was simply mind-blowing

Feature



Hans Rosling, known for the GapMinder bubble graph making a point during a morning session



Watch Pranav Mistry's presentation at TEDIndia 2009 in Mysore at tinyurl.com/TD0912PM



Budi Hal manages to augment reality with E3iT (Engage, Entertain, Educate, Immerse Technology)

today, it seems true. 3M's MPro 120 VGA pocket projector costs around \$350 as of now, but that could change in a few years.

The mobile computer needs something similar to a PC revolution, where consumers can customise their mobile hardware, choose a chipset, RAM, and battery out of easily available parts. There's a Tegra chipset the size of a RAM stick, which on the Zune HD consumes less than 300 milliwatts of power, while rendering amazing graphics and HD video. Like everything, such movements start from the fringe, who knows where

this could take us? Will the stringers of the future wear cyborg-chique gear and get paid for their live feeds? Allow me to regale you with another nugget of wisdom from a TED talk: The computer was dreamt and conceived of centuries before we achieved the means and the technology to develop it.

Budi Hal's system, which he called E3iT (Engage, Entertain, Educate, Immerse Technology) can be worn like a pair of goggles, and takes the user into a virtual reality tour. His theme was Digital Hampi, where he overlaid historical

monuments with a layer of interactive data. "We are trying to explore the possibility of using human computer interface technology to explore the past," he said.

Scott Cook, founder of Intuit, demonstrated how farmers in India were able to net 20 per cent more income by tapping into local data about market prices on their mobile phones. It takes years for them to get that kind of growth, but a simple, low-end application created by his group had enabled them to reap higher profit margins.

TED India fellow Sean Blagsvedt runs a start-up out of Bangalore called Babajobs.com. The web site connects job seekers from the informal sector to employers. Using a mentor-based system, friends, relatives, NGOs, and cyber-café operators can socially network maids, cooks, drivers, and child-caretakers, give them a positive reference so that they can apply for nearby-jobs using mobile phones. The web site lists 3,09,716 jobs and 58,268 job seekers thus far. We checked the web site twice in the span of three days - it had added 1494 jobs, and 500 job seekers.

We asked Sean what was the biggest ideas he had taken from TEDIndia. He cited Anil Gupta's presentation on rural entrepreneurship. "The elites are not the only ones with innovative ideas with spreading. We must determine more ways to showcase



Each day had its dose of entertainment